



ANCHORA DESIGN SYSTEM · 1.0

Precision for every student journey.

A practical design language for Anchora's application control tower — built to make urgency visible, progress legible, and complex operations feel calm.

01 · PRECISE

Every label, date, and status supports an operational decision.

02 · CALM

Urgency is factual and visible without making the workspace feel alarming.

03 · ACCOUNTABLE

Students and consultants share clarity while official control stays explicit.



FOUNDATION 01

Color

Ink carries authority, white space creates calm, gold marks focus, and red remains a controlled signal. Feature code uses semantic roles rather than palette names.

BRAND-INK Brand ink #18181B	BRAND-GOLD Brand gold #EAB308	BRAND-GOLD-STRONG Gold text #A16207	BRAND-RED Brand red #D32F2F
CANVAS Canvas #F8F8FC	SURFACE Surface #FFFFFF	SURFACE-MUTED Muted surface #F1F5F9	BORDER-STRONG Strong border #CBD5E1
Success Text #15803D Surface #F0FDF4 Border #BBF7D0		Warning Text #B45309 Surface #FFFBE8 Border #FDE68A	
Danger Text #B91C1C Surface #FEF2F2 Border #FECACA		Information Text #1D4ED8 Surface #EFF6FF Border #BFDDBF	



Gold is a focus color

Use bright gold decoratively or with brand ink. Use the darker gold text token for copy on white surfaces.



FOUNDATION 02

Typography

Anchora uses Inter only. Hierarchy comes from disciplined scale, weight, rhythm, and tabular numerals — not extra font families.

Display XL

48 / 52 · Bold

Every journey, controlled.

Display LG

40 / 44 · Bold

Application control tower

Page title

24 / 32 · Semibold

Students

Section title

20 / 28 · Semibold

Global requirements

Component title

16 / 24 · Semibold

Winter 2027

Body LG

16 / 26 · Regular

Give each journey enough context to support the next decision.

Body MD

14 / 22 · Regular

Consultants see who needs attention today.

Body SM

13 / 20 · Regular

Due 17 Jul 2026 · due today

Micro label

11 / 16 · Semibold

APPLICATION JOURNEY

DATES AND COUNTS

**17 Jul 2026 · 08 /
12**

Use tabular numerals wherever values are compared vertically or updated in place.

SENTENCE CASE



At risk



In progress



Not started

Use sentence case for product labels; reserve uppercase for compact structural headings.



FOUNDATION 03

Supporting scales

A four-pixel spacing grid and limited radii, elevation, motion, and icon sizes keep Anchora dense enough for operations without feeling compressed.

SPACING · 4PX BASE

04		4px
08		8px
12		12px
16		16px
24		24px
32		32px
48		48px
64		64px

RADIUS



ELEVATION



MOTION AND ICONS

120	180	280	350
Instant	Fast	Standard	Deliberate


16 control


20 nav


32 empty



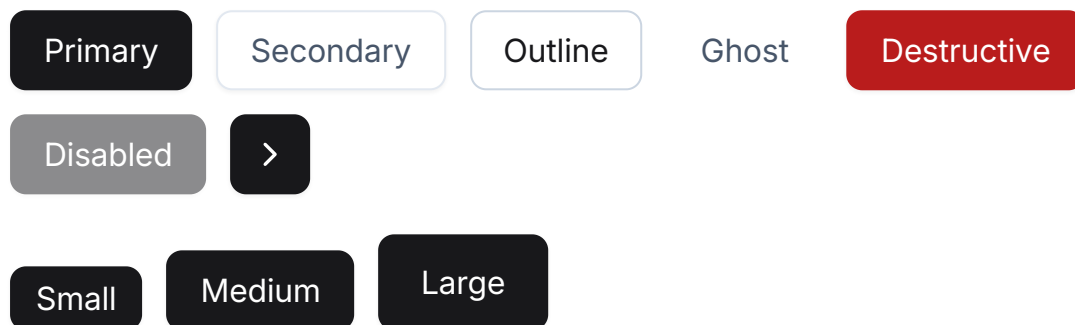
SYSTEM 01

Components

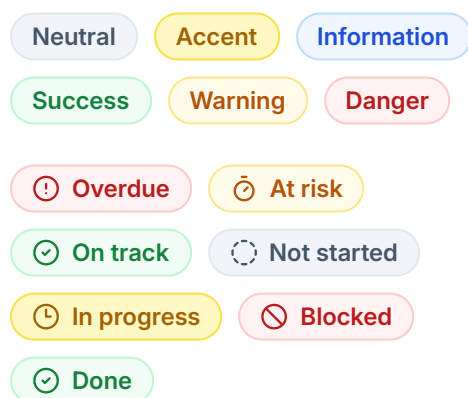
Components encode states, focus behavior, targets, and semantic tone so feature teams assemble consistent interfaces instead of restyling controls.

Buttons

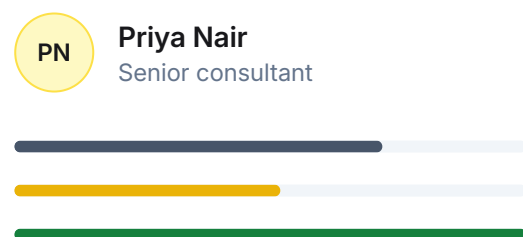
One clear primary action per region.



Badges and status



Progress and identity



Form controls

Student name *

e.g. Rahul Verma

Target intake

Winter 2027

Work email

name@

❗ Enter a valid email address

☒ Show completed tasks

Feedback states

ℹ **Information**

The portal is read-only for students.

✅ **Saved**

The task status is up to date.

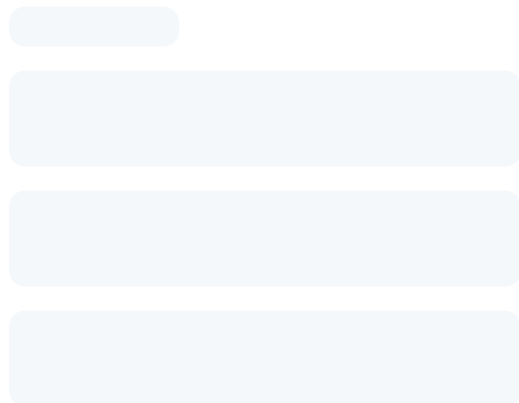
⚠ **Deadline approaching**

This item is due within seven days.

❗ **Status not saved**

Try the update again.

Loading



No documents yet

Uploaded documents will appear here when this capability is introduced.

[Return to journey](#)



SYSTEM 02

Operational patterns

Patterns translate the foundations into Anchora's recurring work: scanning risk, filtering a caseload, reading a journey, and acting on deadlines.

Students > Aarav Sharma

STUDENT JOURNEY

Aarav Sharma

Winter 2027 · Priya Nair

View portal

⚠ Overdue

2

A task is past due — act today

⌚ At risk

3

A task is due within seven days

✅ On track

11

No urgent deadline right now

🔍 Search students...

All risk

All consultants

RISK

STUDENT

NEXT DEADLINE

PROGRESS

⚠ Overdue



Aarav Sharma
aarav@example.com

LOR 2
17 Jul 2026 · due today

6 / 12

📘 Responsive rule

Operational tables become stacked cards below the medium breakpoint. Content priority and actions remain unchanged.



GUIDANCE 01

Content and terminology

Anchora sounds calm, exact, and helpful. It names the state, shows the relevant date, and gives a specific recovery path.

✓ Do

"Status not saved. Try the update again."

"17 Jul 2026 · due today"

"Contact Priya Nair, your assigned consultant."

Use consultant consistently.

⚠ Do not

"Oops! Something went wrong."

"Urgent!!!" without an exact date

"Talk to someone for help."

Mix consultant and counsellor.

Approved lifecycle labels

⚠ Overdue

⚠ At risk

✓ On track

⌚ Not started

🕒 In progress

🚫 Blocked

✓ Done



GUIDANCE 02

Accessibility baseline

WCAG 2.2 AA is the product baseline. Accessibility is part of the component contract, not a finishing pass.



Contrast

Normal text reaches 4.5:1; large text and interface graphics reach 3:1.



No color-only status

Every state combines semantic color with text and an icon.



Keyboard and focus

Logical order, visible focus, skip links, and no keyboard traps.



Target size

Interactive targets meet the 24 by 24 pixel WCAG minimum; primary controls are larger.



Reduced motion

Motion collapses for users who request reduced movement.



Forms and errors

Labels, required state, descriptions, and recovery messages are programmatically connected.

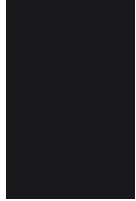
QUALITY GATE

Can someone understand and operate this without sight, color, precision pointing, or motion?

Verify keyboard access, VoiceOver reading order, 200% zoom, target size, focus visibility, reduced motion, and semantic landmarks on every new pattern.

DATA VISUALIZATION GUIDANCE

Use ink for the primary series, gold for a selected or comparative series, and semantic colors only when the data itself represents success, warning, danger, or information. Label every series directly and never depend on hue alone.



Ink · primary



Gold · comparison



Semantic · meaning

✔ Use

- Direct labels beside the data.
- Consistent baselines and ordering.
- One highlighted comparison at a time.

❗ Avoid

- Status colors used decoratively.
- Meaning communicated by hue alone.
- More series than the decision requires.

